TIP As with most of Razor Pages, the search locations are conventions that you can customize. If you find the need, you can customize the paths as shown here: http://mng.bz/nM9e.

The Razor code contained in a partial view is almost identical to a standard view. The main difference is the fact that partial views are called only from other views. The other difference is that partial views don't run _ViewStart.cshtml when they execute. You'll learn about _ViewStart.cshtml shortly in section 17.4.4.

NOTE Like layouts, partial views are typically named with a leading underscore.

Child actions in ASP.NET Core

In the legacy .NET Framework version of ASP.NET, there was the concept of a *child action*. This was an MVC controller action method that could be invoked from *inside* a view. This was the main mechanism for rendering discrete sections of a complex layout that had nothing to do with the main action method. For example, a child action method might render the shopping cart in the corner of every page on an e-commerce site.

This approach meant you didn't have to pollute every page's view model with the view model items required to render the shopping cart, but it fundamentally broke the MVC design pattern by referencing controllers from a view.

In ASP.NET Core, child actions are no more. *View components* have replaced them. These are conceptually quite similar in that they allow both the execution of arbitrary code and the rendering of HTML, but they don't directly invoke controller actions. You can think of them as a more powerful partial view that you should use anywhere a partial view needs to contain significant code or business logic. You'll see how to build a small view component in chapter 32.

Partial views aren't the only way to reduce duplication in your view templates. Razor also allows you to put common elements such as namespace declarations